

LIMINA

From Threshold to City

Works of Jaegyu LEE | 2026

Jaegyu LEE

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I consider the breakdown of ties between people to be one of the great problems of our time, and above all an urban question. It is, in fact, the subject of my bachelor’s thesis. Once, in the past, the alley or the shade of the village’s big tree were places where people greeted one another and stopped to talk. The city cut into functional zones, by contrast, empties out as soon as the activity stops. Architecture cannot, on its own, recreate these ties. It can multiply the occasions for them, and make people stop and stay in places where they would usually only pass through. These occasions often arise in thresholds and small details, such as a bench, a step to sit on, or an access gallery wide enough to become a shared balcony. That is why I want to design at every scale, from the door handle to the city, and to give each scale a clear intention.

EDUCATION

09.2024 - Present	École Spéciale d’Architecture (ESA), Paris - Bachelor in Architecture
03.2021 - 10.2021	One semester in Agricultural Engineering, Kyungpook National University, South Korea

EXPERIENCE

01.2026 - 02.2026	Clément Blanchet Architecture (Intern)
07.2025 - 08.2025	Habitat for Humanity Korea (Intern)
01.2022 - 10.2023	Military Service (Air Force)

SKILLS

Drafting / CAD	AutoCAD, QGIS
3D Modeling	Rhino, Grasshopper
Rendering	D5Render, Enscape
Post-production	Adobe Photoshop, InDesign, Illustrator
Office Software	Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint)
Soft Skills	Physical Models, Hand Drawing, Architectural Sketching
Digital Tools	Python / Rhino-Grasshopper scripting (custom AI-assisted tool, TerrainLaser) (Basic-Intermediate)

LANGUAGES

French	B2 level (DELFI certificate obtained in March 2026)
English	Professional level
Korean	Native language

INTERESTS

Travel, Photography, Baseball, Cooking, Reading & Writing about Architecture

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The City in Continuity

Rethinking links across infrastructure, landscape and districts

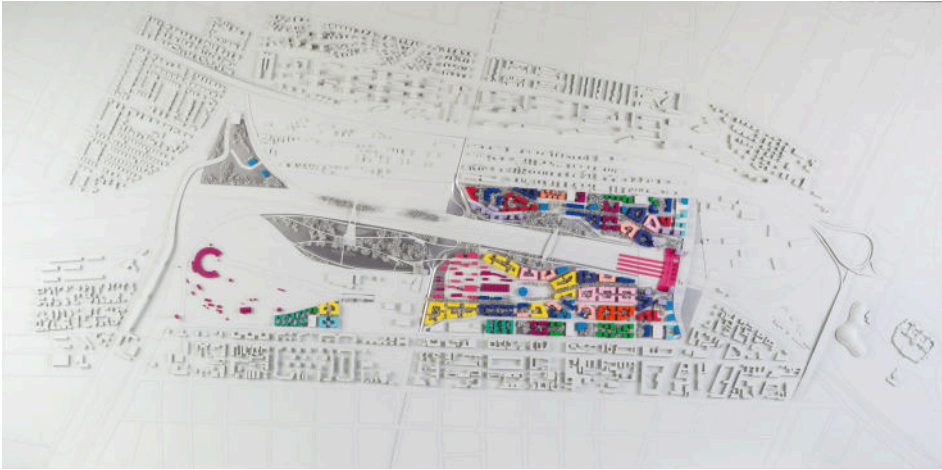
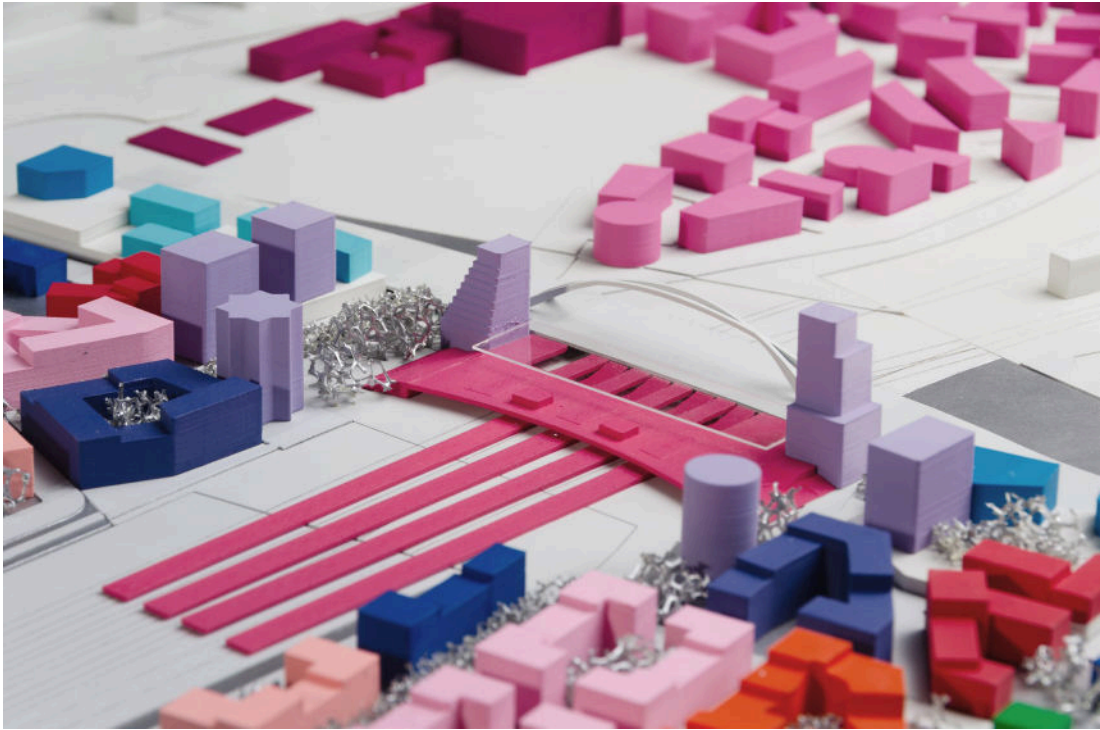
Year: 2026
Type: Urban project
Program: Mixed-use district
Site: Rákosszentimre, Budapest, Hungary
Framework: Office project — Internship
Team: Clément Blanchet Architecture
FBIS Architects
Gustafson Porter + Bowman
Role: Project assistant

During my internship I worked on the masterplan for the Rákosszentimre railway site in Budapest. The tracks there divide the neighborhoods. The project stitches them back together around a linear park and lets the existing traces guide a mixed-use district built in five phases over about twenty-five years. It was my first project at the scale of a whole city. I produced the masterplan graphics and learned how an urban plan is made.

How can a fragmented territory be reconnected without erasing the existing city's traces?



Physical model made by a professional model maker



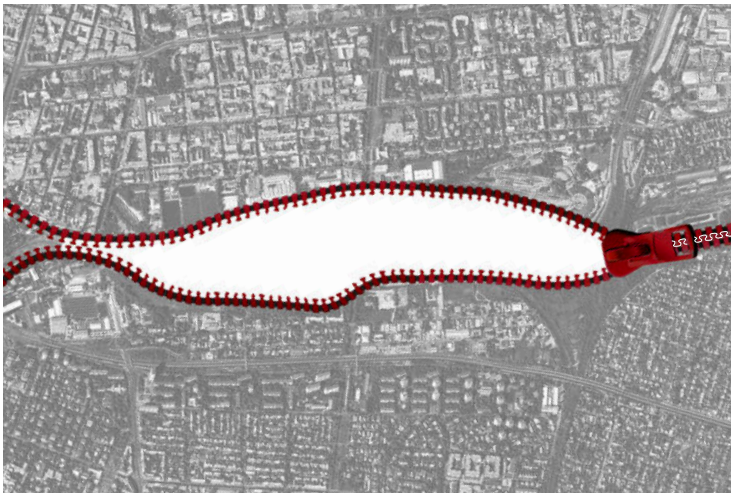
Physical model made by a professional model maker

URBAN STRUCTURE — Articulating the different scales

Densities concentrate around the station and the new residential districts. Heights and typologies change with the proximity of the main hubs. Between these districts the linear park makes the link.

PHASING — Building the city progressively

The district is built in five phases over roughly twenty-five years. Everything starts from the existing infrastructure on site. The city then expands around the station and reaches the public spaces and residential districts. The park and the extensions come last.



I. Stitching the City Back Together

The railway corridor has long cut the city in two. It becomes a landscape framework that can be crossed at several points and that links the neighboring districts to the rest of the territory on both sides of the tracks.



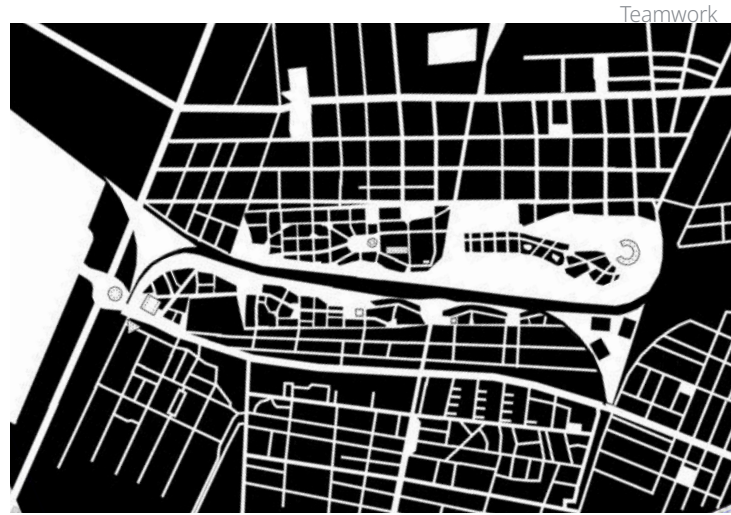
II. Creating Diversity within Unity

Typologies and heights change from one block to the next, and so do the public spaces. One composition brings them together. Each part of the district keeps its character without losing the coherence of the whole.



III. Reinterpreting Budapest's Identity

The project draws on the history of Budapest. It recalls the generosity of its spaces and its link to the landscape. These qualities are reinterpreted so that the territory changes phase by phase without losing its identity.



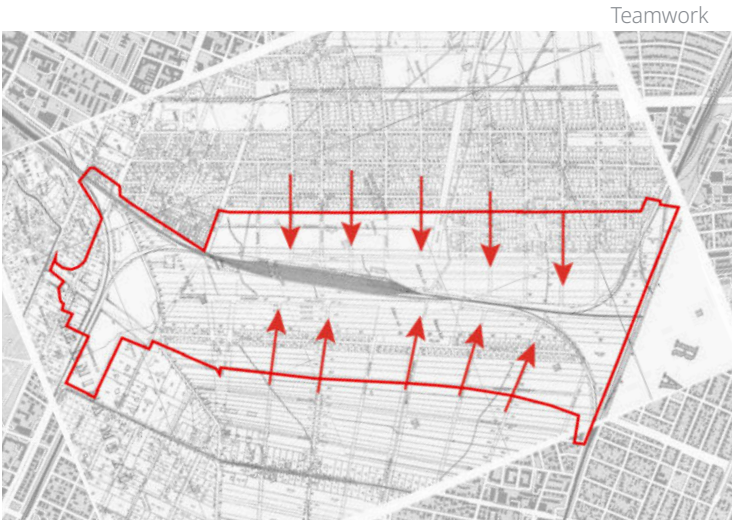
IV. Revealing Historic Connections

Old routes and existing mobility axes are first surveyed and then reactivated. They draw the new connections between the districts and attach the project to the fabric of the city that surrounds it.



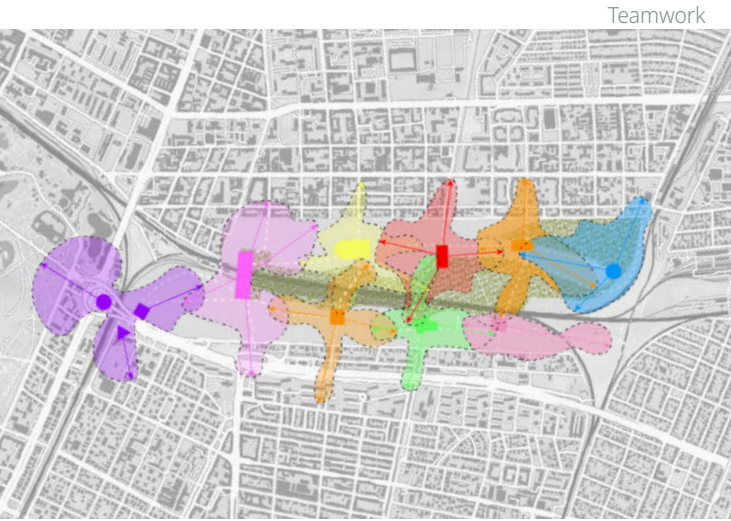
V. Creating Collective Memories

Squares and gardens are designed for everyday uses at the pedestrian scale. People stop there and cross paths. This is how a collective memory can form over time among the inhabitants of the district.



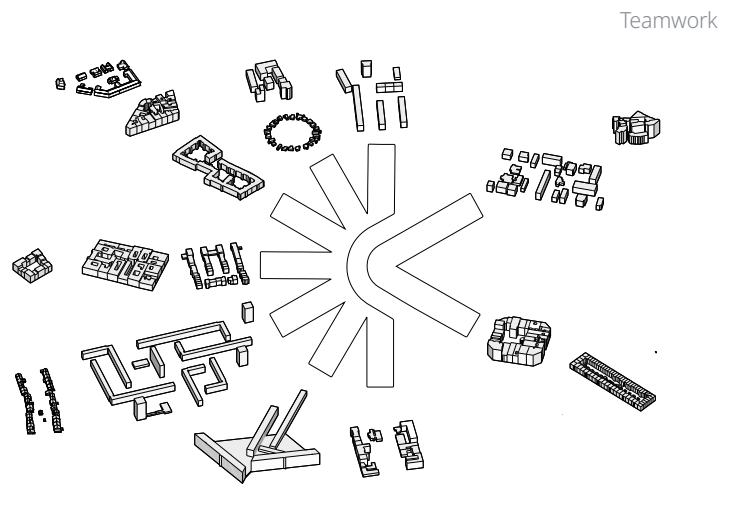
VI. Living in the 15-Minute City

Housing and services are distributed together with facilities and leisure so that daily life stays close at hand. Pedestrian routes and public transport link all these uses together at the scale of the whole district.



VII. Structuring the City through the Park

The linear park carries most of the public spaces and links the districts together. From landscape to built space the transition happens in stages, and one moves gently from the public to the private domain with no sharp boundary.



VIII. Reinterpreting European Urban Heritage

The masterplan takes up what makes the European city. Density and a mix of uses go together with walking and an active public life. The district rests on principles that have already proven their worth.

Team design · Personal graphic layout



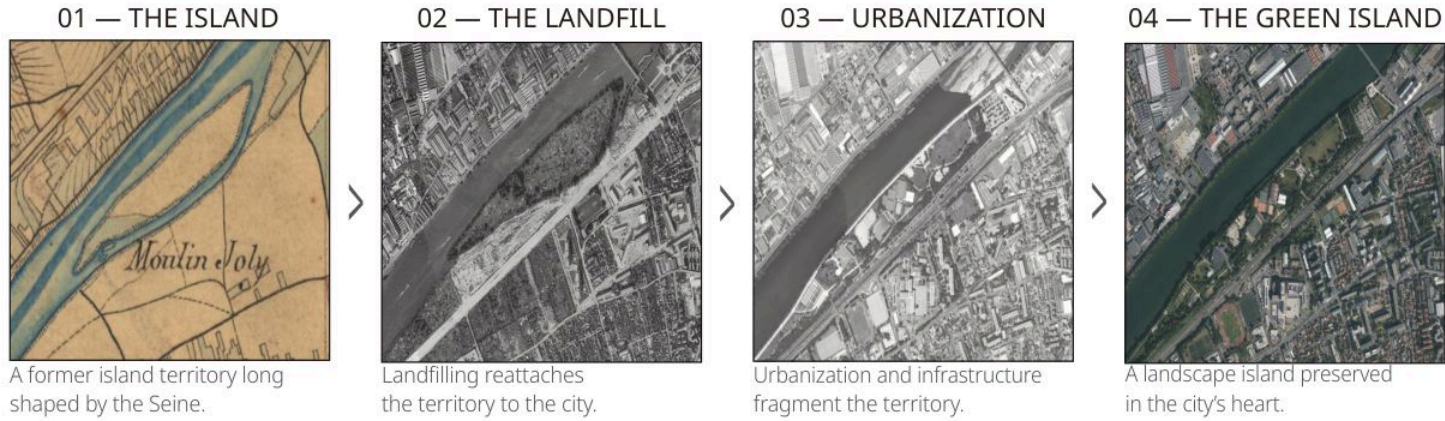
LEGEND

1	4	Central zone	School zone
2	5	Intervention zone	Sports facility
3	Future development	Project perimeter	Parking structure
		Green roof	
		Accessible roof	

The Seine of Cultures

From book to tool, from paper to earth

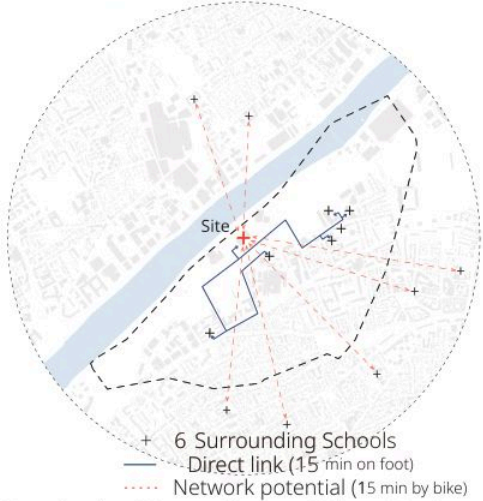
Year: Spring, 2026
Type: Library + hybrid public space
Program: Reading, workshop, canteen, archive
Site: Colombes Ice Rink, Colombes
Concept: Reuse, culture and ecology



Originally an alluvial territory, this site has become a green space, now isolated by the Seine and the major infrastructures, forming a true “green island.” Despite six schools within a 15-minute walk, the neighborhood still lacks shared cultural facilities. This potential invites the creation of a new sociocultural hub that opens onto the city and its inhabitants.

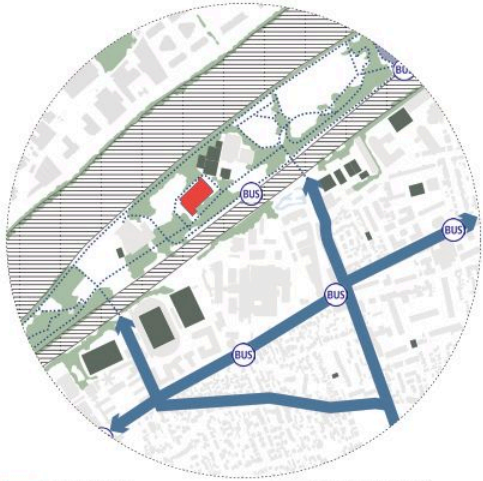
How can this landscape enclave, isolated by metropolitan infrastructure, be turned into a new cultural and ecological territory open to the city and its inhabitants?

Why this site? : Territorial Need



Six schools without a library within a 15-minute radius reveal a shared cultural need and a lack of facilities at the scale of the neighborhood.

URBAN FRAGMENTATION : Fractures and Continuities



Despite the breaks of the motorway and the Seine, the site naturally captures and guides flows.

THE GREEN ISLAND : A Landscape Enclave

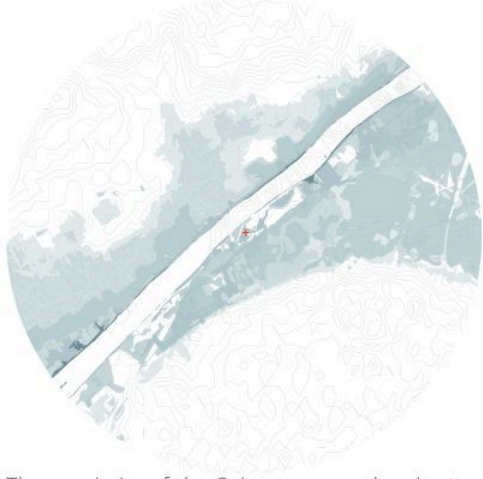


Isolated by the motorway and the Seine, the site today forms a landscape enclave within the surrounding urban fabric. Its strong vegetation gives it the character of a true “green island.”

USES : At the Interface of Activity and Housing



The Floodable Territory : The Seine and Flood Risk

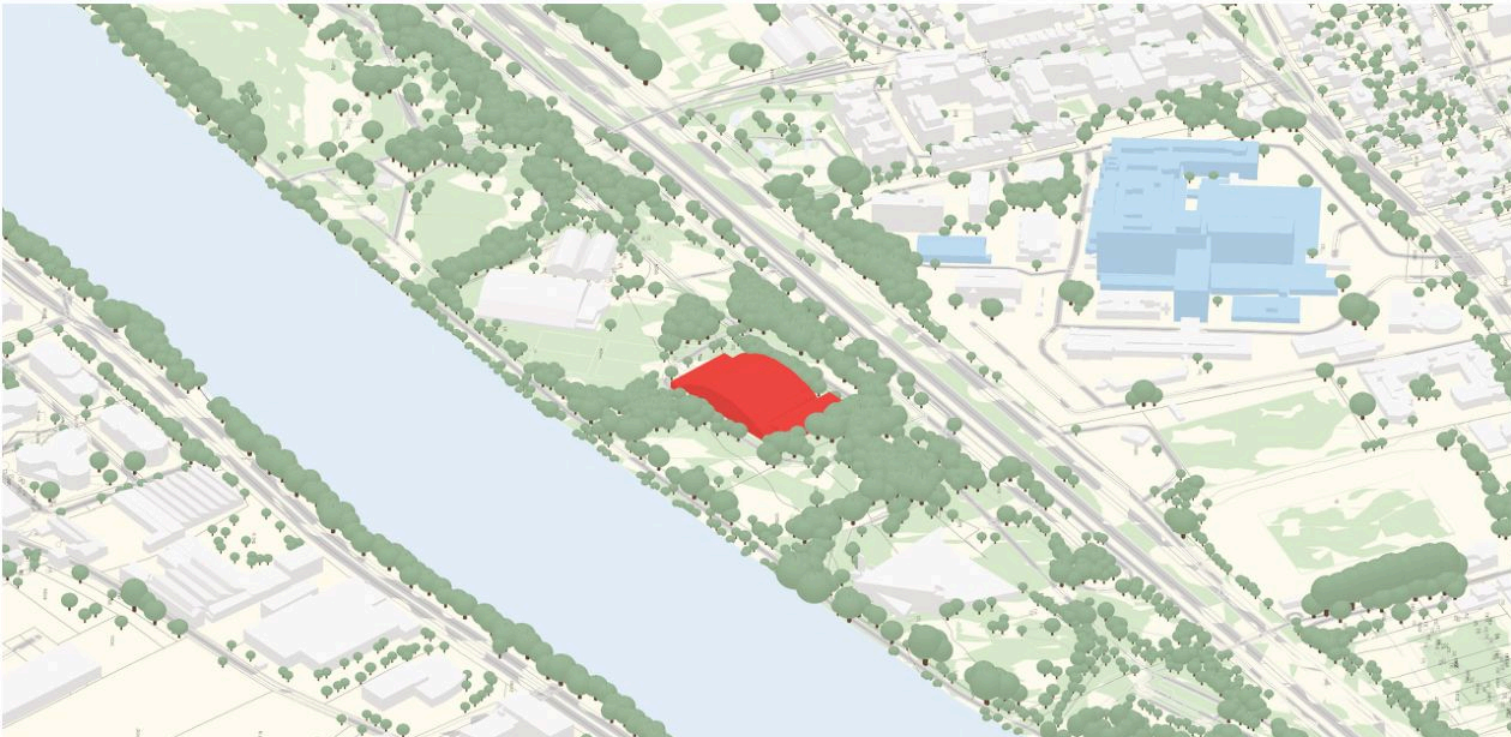


The proximity of the Seine exposes the site to a risk of flooding. The flood zones highlight how vulnerable the territory is to variations in the water level during flood episodes and high water.

GREEN NETWORK : A Green Island in the Urban Tissue



Green spaces are concentrated mainly around the site itself and along the banks of the Seine, creating a privileged landscape setting and an ecological continuity within the urban fabric.



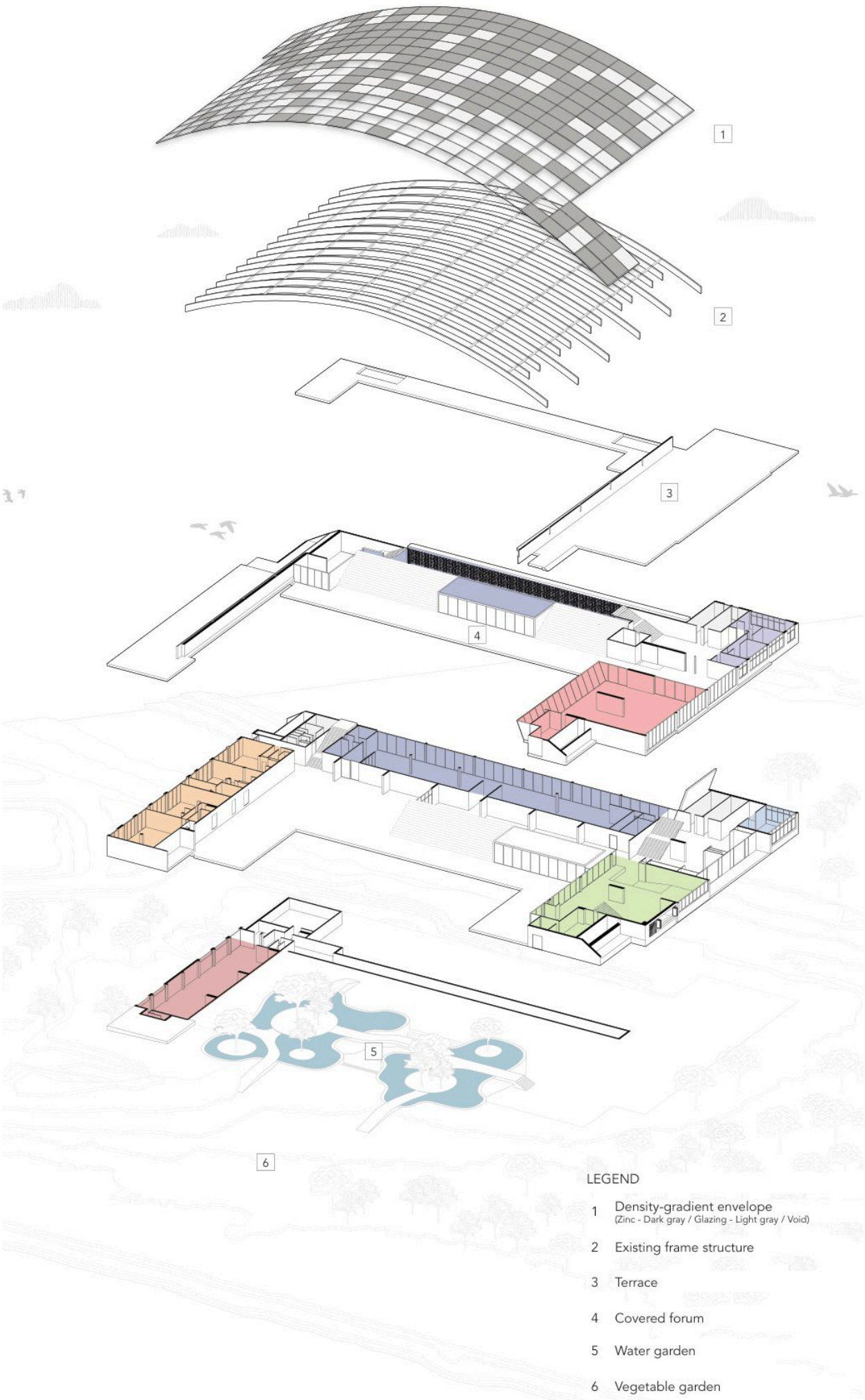
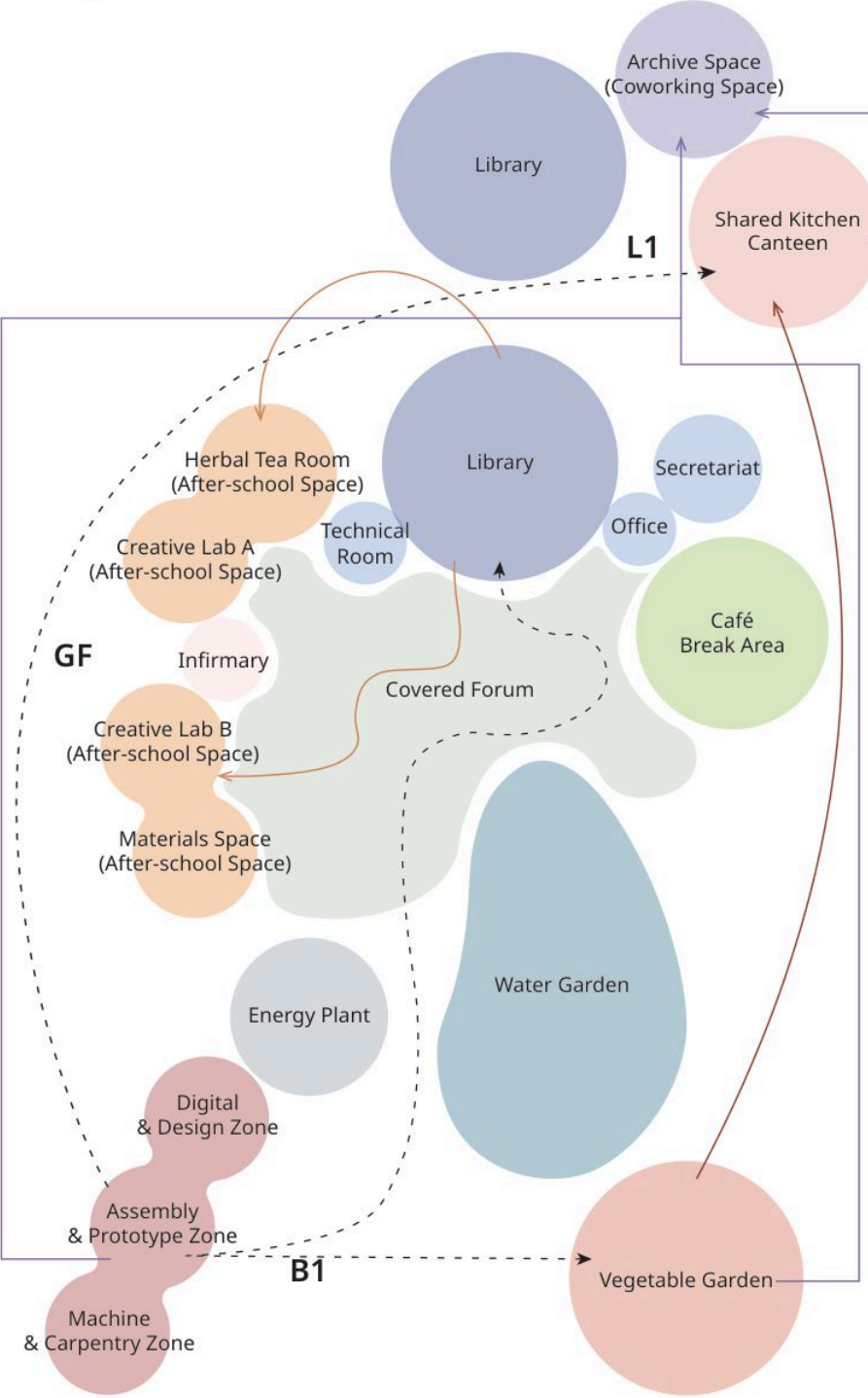
REUSE & CYCLE OF KNOWLEDGE

PROGRAM — The cycle of knowledge

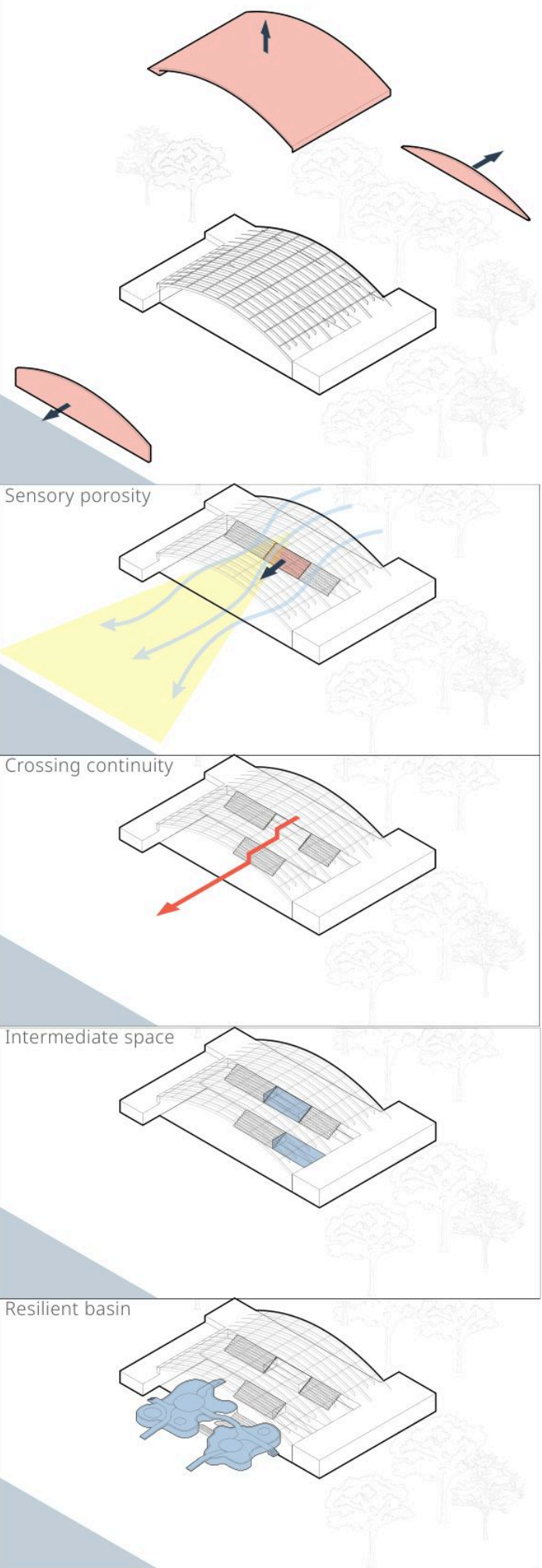
Everything starts in the library, where people come to learn. This knowledge is put to the test in the garden, the workshop and the canteen, where people grow, make and cook. Users record these experiences in the archive space, open to coworking, and turn them into books. These books join the library shelves, and the cycle begins again.

COMPOSITION — From the existing to the landscape

The project keeps the frame of the ice rink and removes part of the facades and of the roof to open the building to the landscape. A ramp leads to the ground floor, where a glazed vestibule marks the passage from outside to inside. The former ice rink floor becomes a water garden that collects the rainwater.



Selective deconstruction

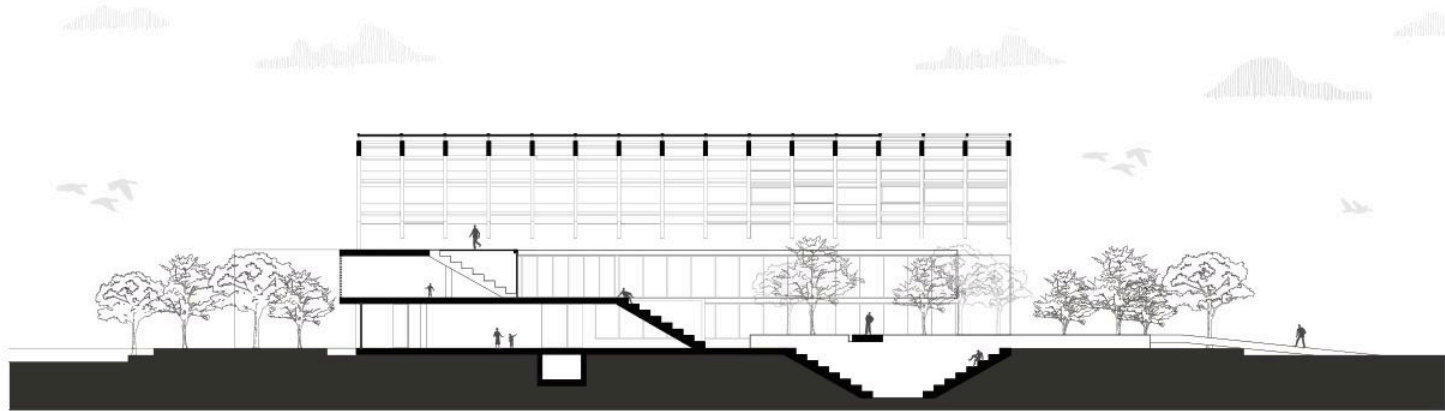
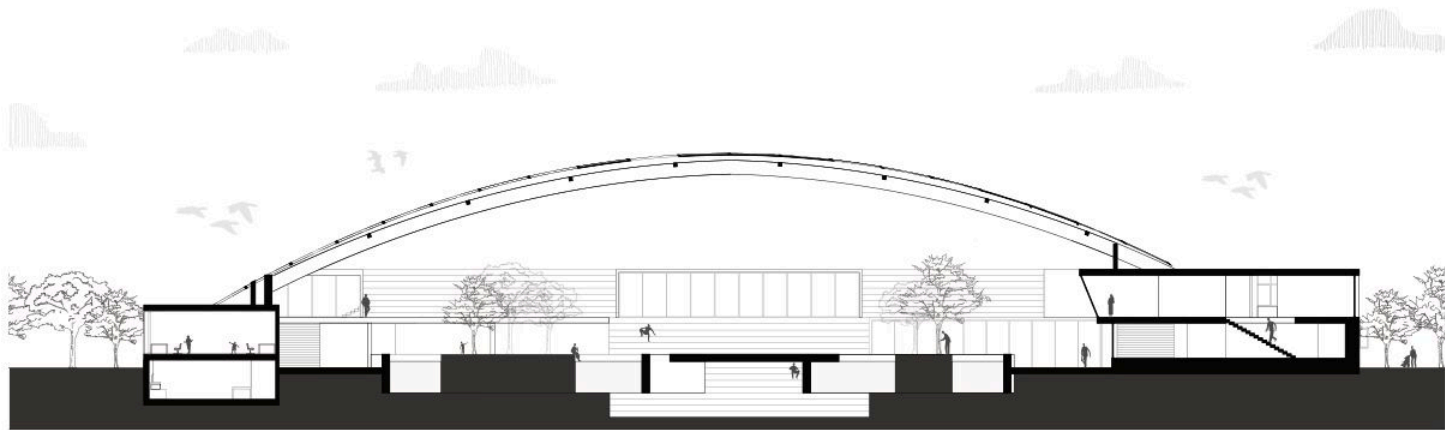


SITE PLAN — From building to landscape

The site is caught between the Seine and the motorway, next to a sports complex and a swimming pool. It lies in a flood zone. The former ice rink stays in place but now faces the river. Between the building and the bank stretches the vegetable garden. Paths cross the gardens down to the basins.



- LEGEND
- 1 The Seine
 - 2 Sports complex
 - 3 Vegetable garden
 - 4 Swimming pool
 - 5 Motorway

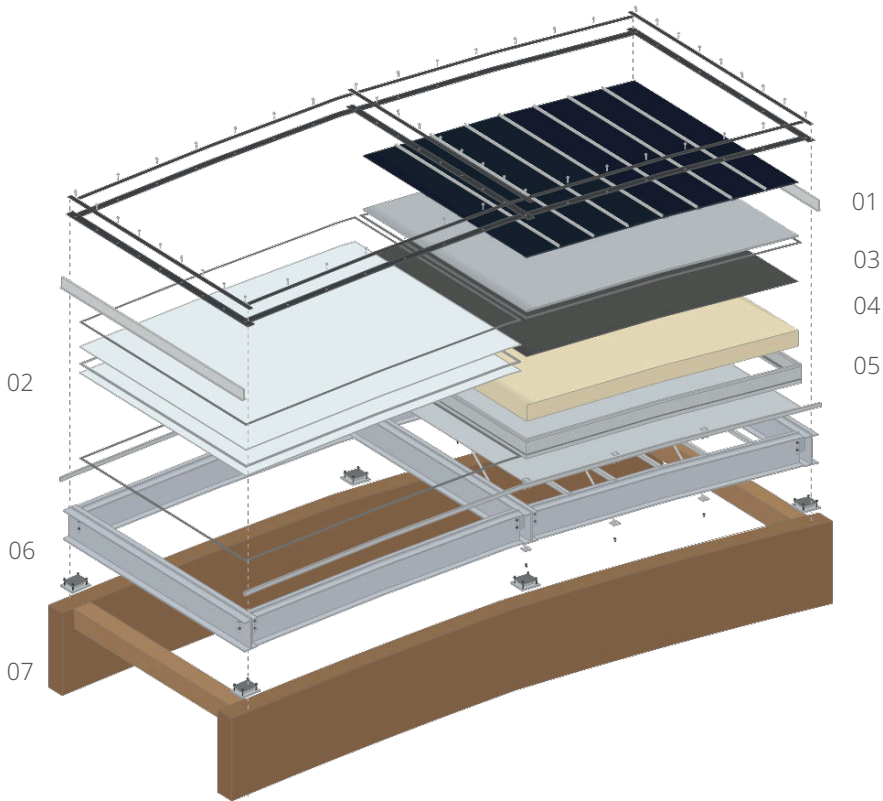


TOPOGRAPHY & CONTINUITY
The building as an extension of the landscape

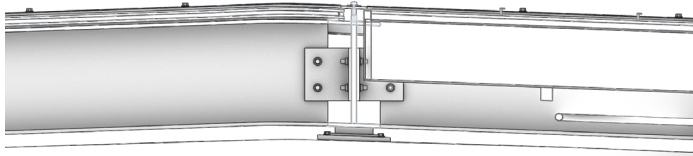
The project refuses a break between building and landscape. The ramp and the changes of level carry the ground through the architecture. One enters gradually through the glazed vestibule and finds the landscape again from the public spaces. The three sections follow this passage from the outside to the inside. The first shows the existing structure with its main glulam timber beams. The second shows the building wide open to the outside. In the third, the ground sinks gradually to the water garden set in the former floor of the ice rink.

EXISTING STRUCTURE
AND NEW ENVELOPE

The old roof covering is stripped away, but the main glulam timber beams and the secondary timber beams are kept in place. It is on this retained frame that the new envelope is laid. It follows the original grid of the structure, and each bay of the grid receives two modules, made of zinc, of glass, or left open. The zinc stays opaque and protects the interior from the weather, while the glass lets natural light in without letting the rain through. The open modules play a different role. They let in air and light, but also the rain, which falls straight down to the water garden on the lower level of the building. The order of the old frame stays clearly legible under a more open roof, adapted to its new uses.



- 01 Photovoltaic panels
- 02 Roof glazing
- 03 Steel deck support
- 04 Waterproofing membrane
- 05 Thermal insulation
- 06 Secondary steel frame
- 07 Existing main beams



RAINWATER MANAGEMENT AND REUSE

Here the rain follows a visible path that recalls how long this site was shaped by the Seine. The large curved roof in zinc and glass shelters the interior from the weather and carries the water down toward its two ends. Gutters and pipes built into the structure bring it down to the lower level of the building. Another part falls into the middle of the central space through the openings left between certain modules. Users can watch it fall from the sky on rainy days. The two paths meet in the water garden that occupies the former pit of the ice rink. The water is stored and filtered there, then reused on the site itself to water the neighboring vegetable garden.



Living with Change

Modularity, porosity and collective life

Personal project
Type: Collective housing + shared space
Program: Housing + neighborhood facilities
Site: Romainville (93), France
Concept: Fixed grid, evolving housing, shared thresholds

In Romainville the housing rests on a 3.30 m grid. Partitions are moved to join two units or to separate them without touching the structure. The dwelling changes size with its inhabitants, from studio to T3. The winter garden enlarges the living space, and the 3 m wide gallery becomes a shared balcony with its benches and plants. Neighbors share a vegetable garden at ground level and another on the roof. People meet there without having to make an appointment.

How can a dwelling follow the different stages of a life, growing or shrinking without anyone ever touching its structure?



MASTERPLAN Organizing the collective void

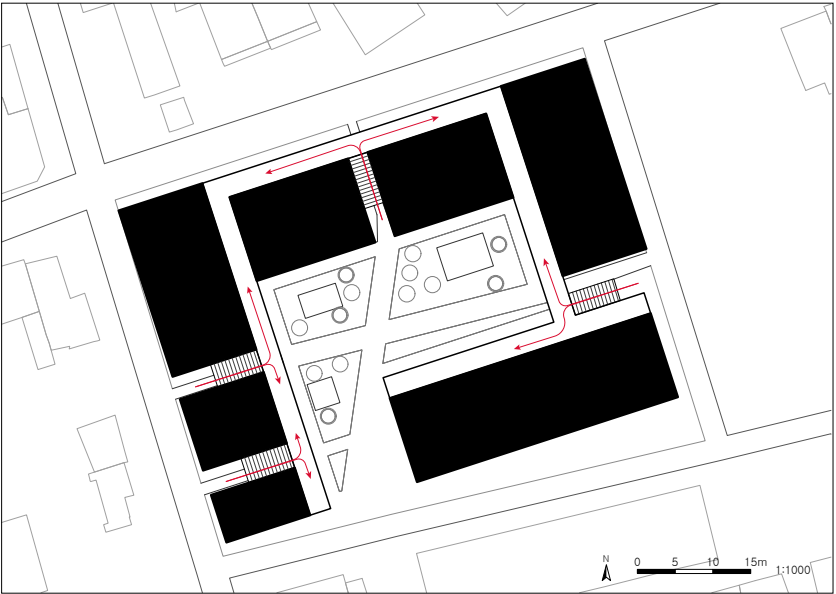
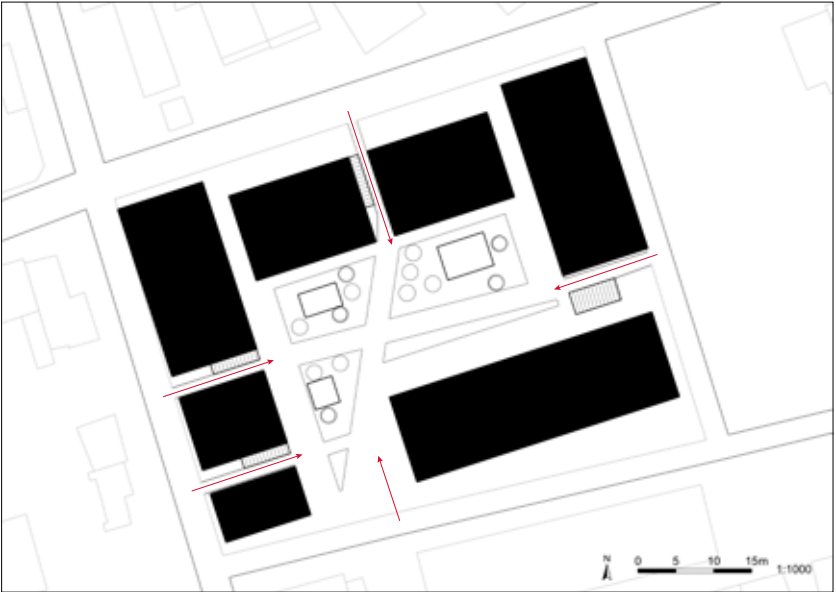
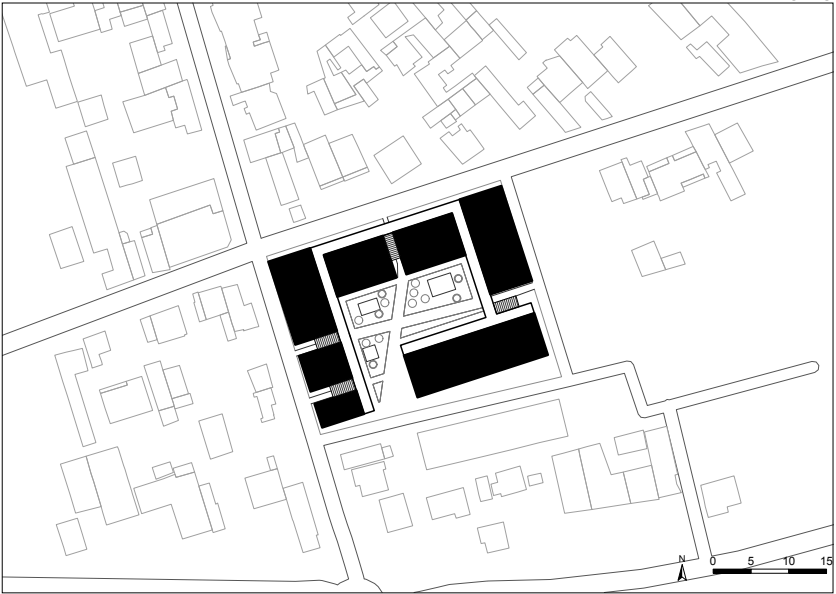
Several housing volumes are arranged around a common garden with benches and a vegetable garden. Between them the buildings break off and the block opens onto the street through a series of passages and small shared gardens. It is the void at the center that holds the whole project together.

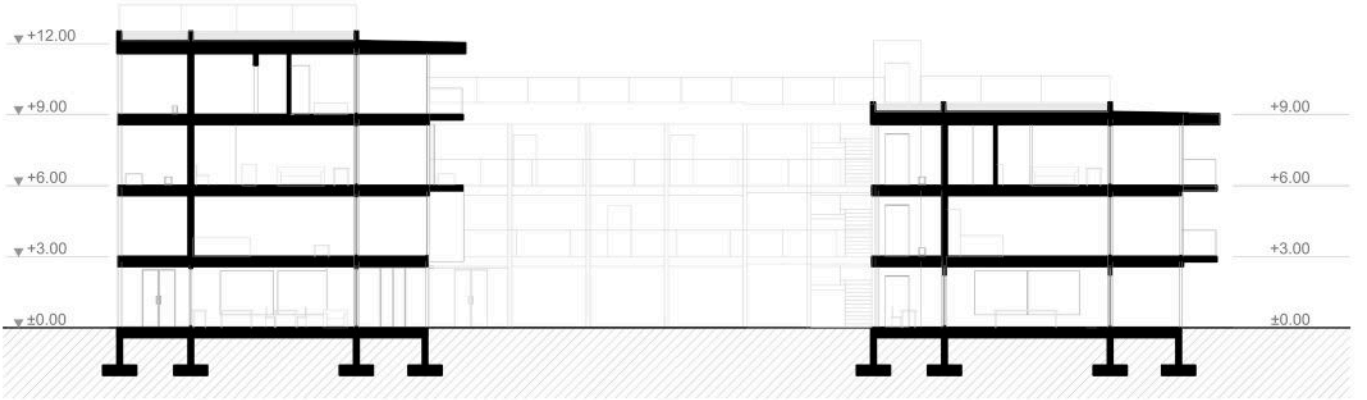
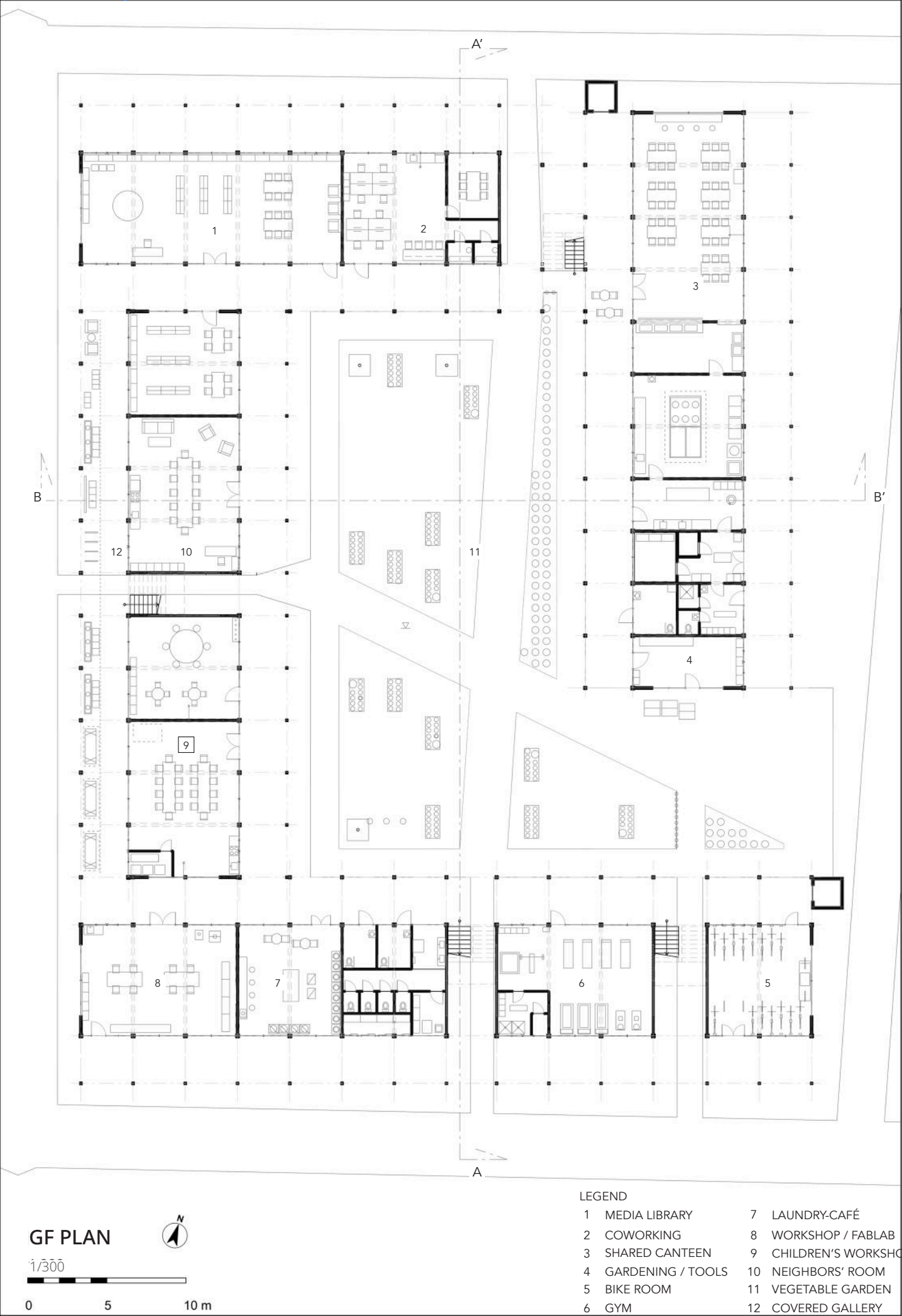
GROUND FLOOR Crossing the block

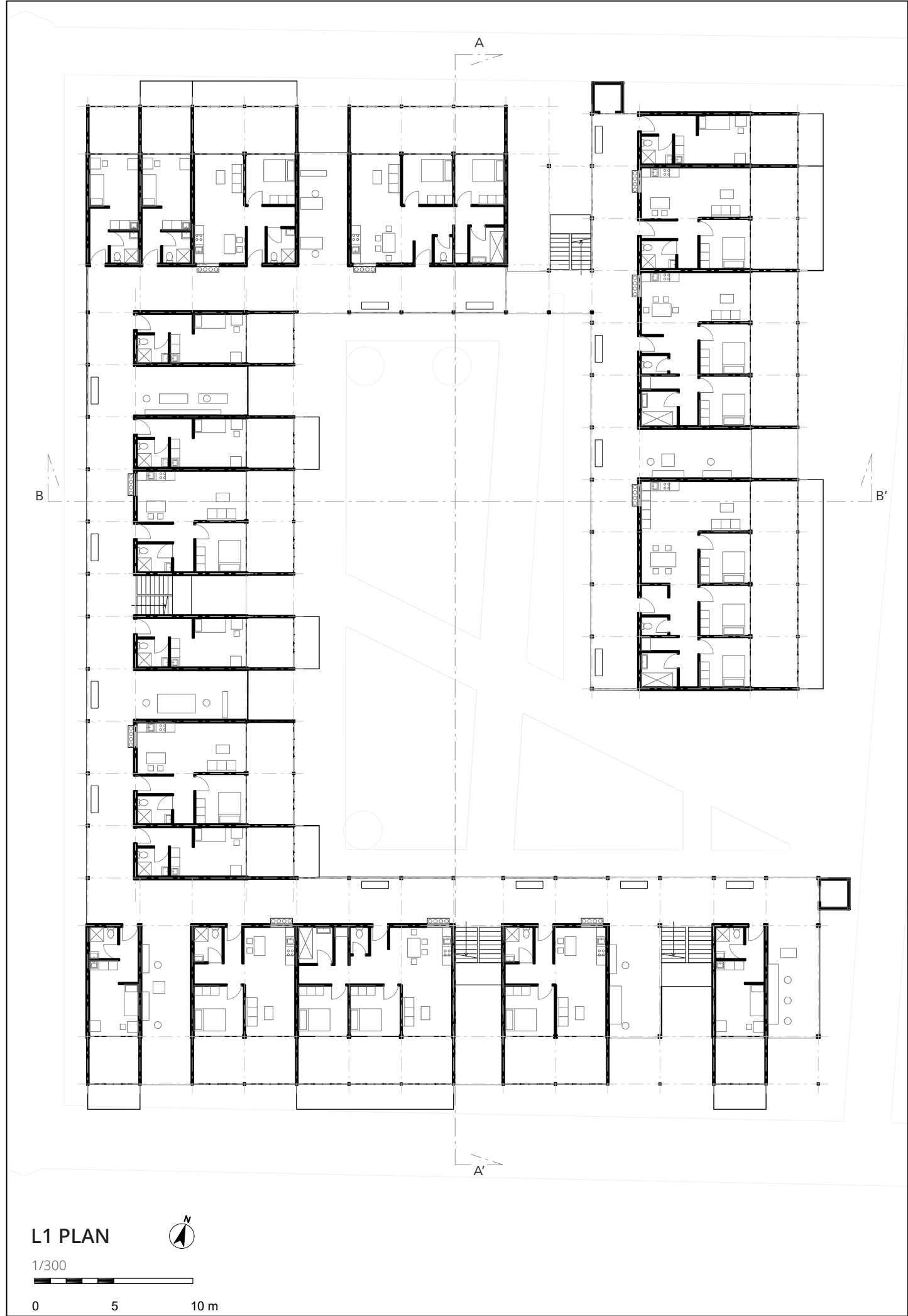
At ground level the passages extend the street to the large central garden. Circulations run right through the buildings and the block does not close in on itself. The entrances to the dwellings and the neighborhood facilities, such as the media library or the laundry-café, open onto these passages that people use every day.

LEVEL 1 The gallery as an inhabited street

Upstairs the galleries run around the inner garden and serve all the dwellings. They are 3 m wide and hold benches and potted plants. People pass along them to get home and stop for a moment to talk to a neighbor. Each gallery becomes a shared balcony for the whole floor of the building.

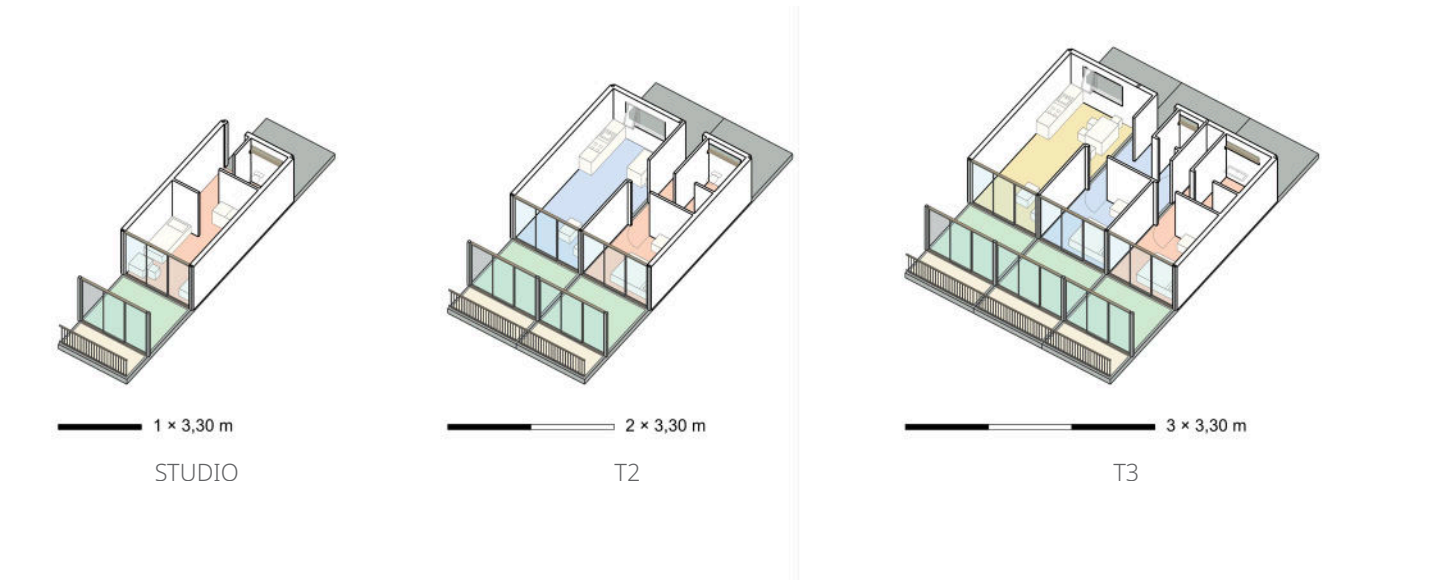






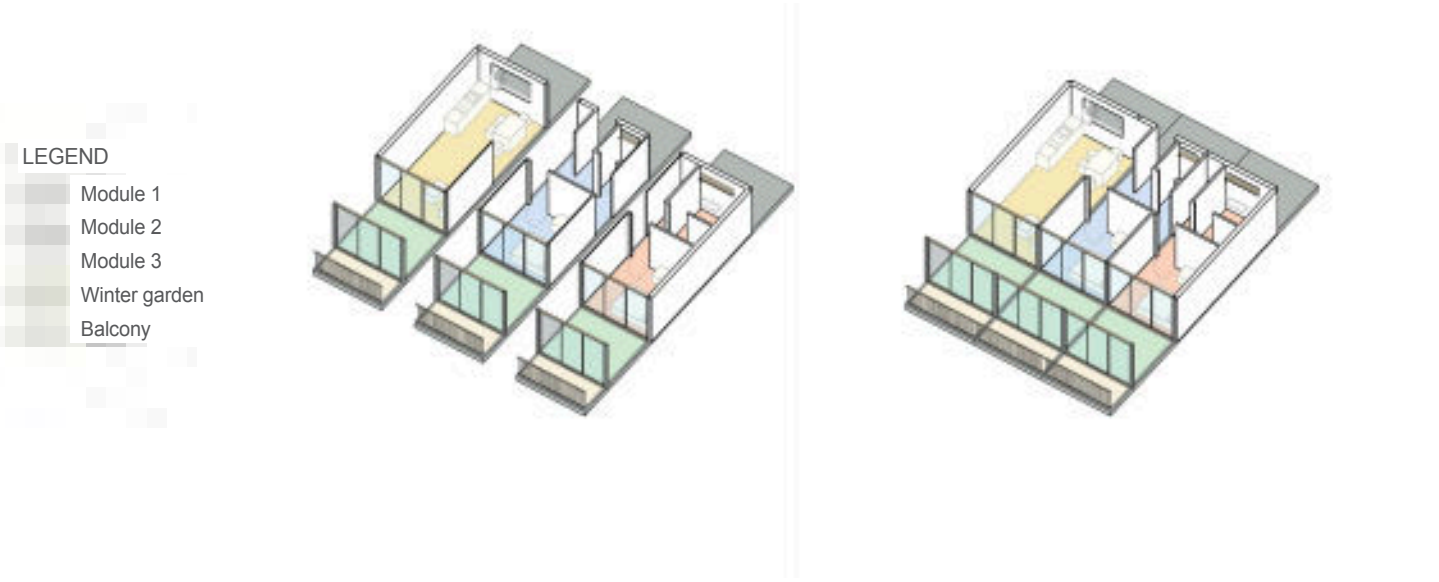
One grid, many ways of living

It all starts from a 3.30 × 7 m module. One module makes a studio, two modules a T2, three a T3: the typologies change, but the grid stays the same from one end of the building to the other.



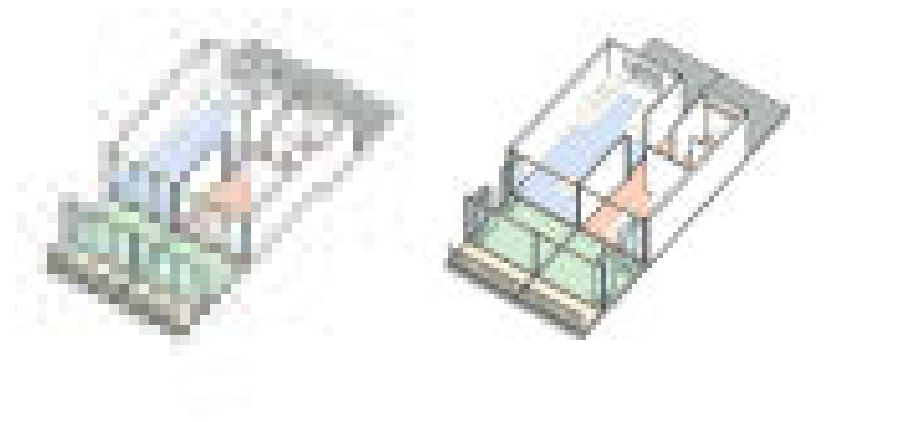
Spaces that adapt

The load-bearing structure does not move. The dividing partitions, however, can be moved to regroup or re-divide the dwellings. A studio becomes a T2 when the family grows; a T3 splits in two when the children leave home. The dwelling follows the different stages of its inhabitants' lives.



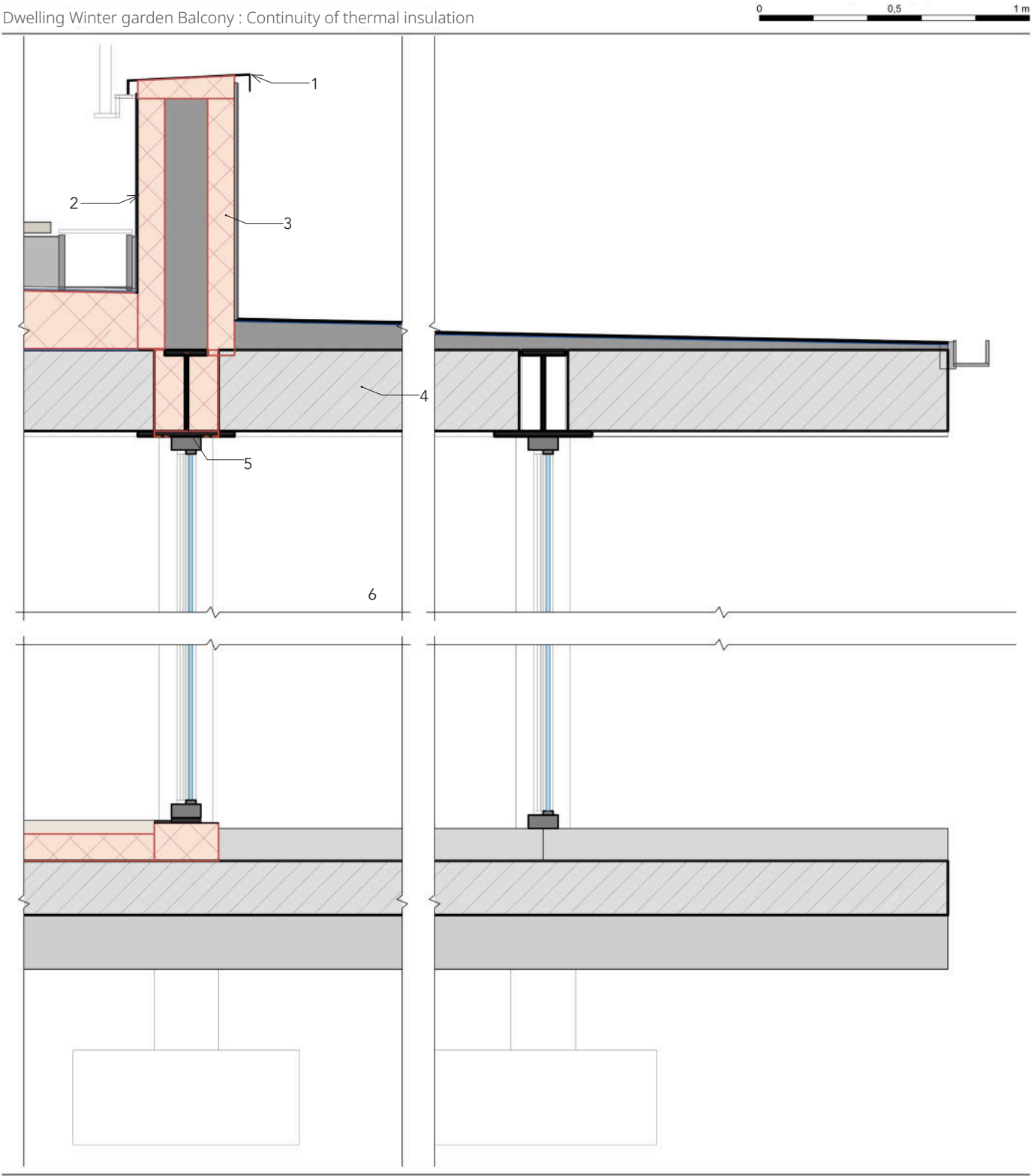
A winter garden through seasons

Between the dwelling and the balcony, the winter garden serves as a transition space. In summer its glass walls open wide and it extends the dwelling outward. In winter they close again and it protects the interior from the cold.

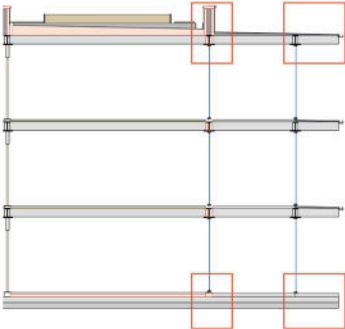


DETAIL SECTION 1/20

Dwelling Winter garden Balcony : Continuity of thermal insulation



LOCATION SECTION 1/250



- LEGEND
- 1 Zinc coping
 - 2 Thermal insulation
 - 3 Waterproofing
 - 4 Reinforced concrete slab
 - 5 Steel H-section beam
 - 6 Winter garden

